PD DAY · OCTOBER 23, 2026 · MCLENNAN COMMUNITY COLLEGE

AI That Actually Helps

Choose a good task. Give AI a clear brief. Check it. Own it.

Participant handout

Turn over to write your prompt →

1 · A simple operating habit

1	2	3	4
CHOOSE	**PROMPT**	**CHECK**	**OWN**
a suitable task	with a clear brief	the result	the final work

AI assists. People remain accountable.

2 · Choose the right task

GOOD FIT

- ☐ Repeatable
- ☐ Text or idea heavy
- ☐ Low risk
- ☐ Easy to verify

PAUSE FIRST

- – Sensitive data
- – High-stakes decisions
- – Facts you cannot verify
- – Institutional commitments

Ask: Can I verify this, and should this information leave my hands?

3 · Give AI a useful brief

KEEP THIS

PURPOSE	What should it help you accomplish?	**CONTEXT**	What does it need to know?
CONSTRAINTS	What must it protect or follow?	**OUTPUT**	What should the response look like?

Help me [purpose]. Use [context].
Follow [constraints]. Return [output].

VAGUE vs. USEFUL

× “Write an email about registration.”

✓ “Draft a warm 120-word reminder for returning students. Explain the next two steps. Use plain language and a helpful tone. End with one clear action.”

Never enter student names, ID numbers, grades or other personal information into an AI tool. (MCC Faculty/Part-time Instructors Handbook §1.11)

MCC Copilot works for every activity today.

Build your prompt

Describe the task, not the people. No names, IDs or grades.

My recurring task

Good fit? ☐ Yes ☐ Pause first

PURPOSE · Help me…
What should it help you accomplish?

CONTEXT · Use…
What does it need to know? Audience, background, what happened before.

CONSTRAINTS · Follow…
What must it protect or follow? Length, tone, policy, what not to invent.

OUTPUT · Return…
What should the response look like? Format, length, number of options.

My full prompt

Help me [purpose]. Use [context]. Follow [constraints]. Return [output].

Check before you use it

☐ Facts, dates and names are right
☐ No missing steps
☐ No protected information
☐ No harmful assumptions
☐ Tone fits the audience
☐ I would send it with my name on it

Within two weeks, I will use AI to: _____